

Delaware County Budget Hearing - October 7th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=s_j0WUdp0sE
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Target Category	delaware_county

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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Not applicable. The transcript begins directly with the regular meeting proceedings.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the meeting, leading into ongoing council business and roll call. The transcript notes proceedings of the Delaware County Council.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present (by roll call):** Mr. Flanagan, Mr. Whitehead, Mr. Mogul, Mr. Bookout, Ms. Piper, Mr. Kance, Mr. Hughes.
 - **Presiding Officer / Key Figures:** Judge Calhoun (Board of Judges), Judge/Council leadership.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not explicitly recorded in the provided text.
- **Approval of Minutes:** 00:08:30 Motion to approve prior meeting minutes as amended by Dan, seconded by Jessica. Approved via roll call vote (all members voting "yes").

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:18:08 Resolution 2026-013: Resolution Requesting Correction of Inadvertent Failure to Adopt the Airport Tax Rate for 2026**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Auditors Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addresses an administrative oversight from the prior year where the airport's budget was approved, but the tax rate was omitted. Authorizes an appeal to the DLGF for a tax rate of 0.133, translating to a property tax levy of approximately one hundred thousand dollars.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve by Eugene, seconded by Jessica. Passed via roll call vote (7-0: Flanagan, Whitehead, Mogul, Bookout, Piper, Kance, Hughes voting aye).
- **00:20:10 Resolution 2026-010: Adoption of the Delaware County Budget**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishes the county general adopted budget at \$45,243,080, with an adopted tax levy of \$31,200,000 and a tax rate of 69.51 cents, alongside individual fund budgets and rates (reassessment, cumulative bridge, health). Council discussed equity concerns regarding across-the-board vs. tiered salary increases, noting efforts to prioritize public safety (jail turnover) while acknowledging salary study benchmarks.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **00:08:52 Judge Calhoun** (representing the Board of Judges) spoke during the budget consideration, asking the council to delay the budget vote by a couple of weeks to re-evaluate employee raise percentages. Expressed concern that uneven percentage increases across departments (e.g., 2% vs. 4%-5%) send an unintended message that certain branches (such as court staff vs. Casa or public safety) are undervalued, and urged revisiting equity or considering departmental lump-sum "buckets" for distribution.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve by Eugene, seconded by Jessica. Passed via roll call vote (7-0: Flanagan, Whitehead, Mogul, Bookout, Piper, Kance, Hughes voting aye).
- **00:27:27 Resolution 2026-011: Adoption of the 2027 Airport Authority Budget**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adopts tax rates of 3.08 cents for the special airport general fund and 0.31 cents for the special airport cumulative bridge/building funds.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion by Jessica, seconded by Dan. Passed via roll call vote (6-1, with Whitehead voting "no"; Flanagan, Mogul, Bookout, Piper, Kance, Hughes voting aye).
- **00:28:36 Resolution 2026-012: Reduction of Already Appropriated Funds**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / participating departments.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Formalizes budget reductions for funds already appropriated to the Sheriff, Prosecutor, Jail, Public Defender, and County Commissioners totaling \$934,559 in county general, plus \$37,554 under the county LIT budget due to departmental frugality/over-budgeting adjustments.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve by Jessica, seconded by Dan. Passed via roll call vote (7-0: Piper, Bookout, Mogul, Whitehead, Flanagan, Kance, Hughes voting aye).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:34:11 Resident Speaker (Identified as a newsman/author):** Commented on historical court budget actions and questioned whether property taxes would increase due to compounding impacts from ongoing reassessment cycles. Noted high local voter turnout as a sign of anticipated community changes.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Steve Brand (County Commissioners Office):** Clarified that the \$750,000 for exterior facility rehabilitation and Purdue Extension contract adjustments (\$54,000) were successfully captured in the passed budget.
 - **Jeff Stanley (Chief Deputy / Sheriff's Office):** Thanked the council for prioritizing jail staff compensation.
 - **Tom (Surveyor's Office):** Discussed future post-budget adjustments regarding moving an office manager position into the perpetuation fund.
 - **Ryan (IT Department):** Highlighted pay discrepancies in his newly established department and requested discretion in distributing future salary adjustments to bring under-market staff up to parity.
 - **Council Announcements:** Acknowledged improvements in the OpenGov budget format and asked that office communications regarding next year's budget changes be copied to administrative staff (Elizabeth and Tom) by the end of January.
- **Adjournment:** Motion to adjourn by Jessica, seconded by Dan. Approved via roll call vote (7-0: Flanagan, Mogul, Piper, Bookout, Whitehead, Kance, Hughes voting aye). Meeting officially adjourned.